TECHNOVATION Girls

Pre-season - Mentor Checklist

Checklist for a successful Technovation season:

- ☐ Complete **your mentor profile** on our platform
  - ☐ Select a local Chapter or Club, if available. Mentors can still participate in the program even if there is no local Ambassador in their area.
  - ☐ Review the **mentor training** slides & click the button on the last slide to mark completion
  - ☐ Add a **photo** and write an **engaging personal summary** to help you match with a team on the Technovation platform
  - ☐ review and sign the **consent waiver**
  - ☐ mentors in the ***U.S., Canada, India, and Nigeria only*, complete a background check** (right in the dashboard)
- ☐ Review the **mentor resource page** to understand the resources available to you during the season
- ☐ Register for any live Mentor sessions that will help you during the season.
- ☐ **Understand the program and timeline**
  - ☐ Review the competition timeline
  - ☐ Learn more about the competition **submission requirements** & **rules**
- ☐ Find a team
  - ☐ **Reach out to your Chapter or Club Ambassador** (found on your mentor dashboard, if available) in your local area to see if there are teams you can join, or
  - ☐ **Or, search through teams on the platform** and see if they are in your time zone
- ☐ Connect with other mentors
  - ☐ **find a colleague or friend to co-mentor** a team with you to make the season more manageable. To recruit and share information, use this flyer!
  - ☐ **Join our volunteer Slack workspace**to interact with the global mentor community and get tips on leading the program from other mentors.
- ☐ Once you find a team, **email the team members.**
  - ☐ Introduce yourself, and start the discussion about how you'd like to communicate, and find a time for your first team meeting to be based on the suggested timeline
  - ☐ Include the **mentor communication form**

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☐ Review the **student and mentor curriculum**, to start preparing for your first team meeting

Time commitment

Our 4 month program recommends 40+ hours to complete. We know this is a large commitment.

It is up to you to determine how much time you can commit to. Simply make sure to set this expectation with your team from the beginning.

Technovation team recommendation:

Meet with your team once a week, for two hours, and work with at least one co-mentor

Create successful teams

- Teams can be composed of **1 - 5 girls.**
  - If you can, let the girls choose their own teams and avoid assigning team members.
  - Teams will be categorized into the Beginner, Junior or Senior Division based on the age of the oldest member of the team.
    - Each division has a unique set of submission guidelines and judging rubric.
- Working in a team of 1 can be difficult due to the submission requirements. If you have a girl interested in this pathway, help them create a calendar and use the key milestones timeline to help you.

Technovation team recommendation:

Ensure you and the students are on a team on the platform! If you need more help, reach out to your Chapter or Club Ambassador.

Working with your team

- Setup **clear communication guidelines** between parents, mentors and participants on your team, this mentor communication form can help with that.
  - When girls create accounts, a form will be sent to their parents. Parents must give consent for their children to participate in the program.
  - All communication mentors have with students must be monitored by the parent or teacher.

- We do not recommend that mentors exchange phone numbers with students.

Technovation team recommendation:
Create a messaging group or online monitored communication with other adults present, such as your co-mentor, parent, and the teacher if applicable.

- Keep **student safety** top-of-mind
  - Mentors should never be alone with only one student nor message a student privately via social media or texting.
  - A teacher or guardian must accompany the team on field trips or workshops along with the mentor.
  - Find more safety information here.
- Set a **schedule**
  - Review the suggested **timeline** with the team so they stay on target.
  - Agree upon a weekly day/time to meet and stick to it.
  - Set clear expectations with your team. Be conscious and honest about your work and personal life balance.

Technovation team recommendation:
In the first team meeting, pick a weekly day/time to meet and set clear expectations on how many hours you can support them.

Remember, you can revisit the Mentor training modules at any time to refresh on topics throughout the season.

Contact the Volunteer Engagement Team with questions on Slack or at volunteers@technovation.org